ONE DM · A SIX FIGURE YES

FROM DM TO REVENUE

The cold message I sent a stranger, annotated line by line, and the structure underneath it, which works the same on customers, investors and hires.

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WHY THIS EXISTS

I sent one cold message to a founder I'd never met. He replied in thirty minutes, and that message is the reason I'm his business partner today.

People ask me what it said. That's the wrong question, though answering it honestly is about the most useful thing I can do with the message: the words won't transfer to your situation, while the structure underneath them will, whether the yes you need is a customer, an investor or a job.

So here's the message exactly as I sent it, typos left in, with every line explained.

WHAT IT PRODUCED

1	0	30 min
COLD MESSAGE	INTRODUCTIONS	TO HIS REPLY

His entire reply	*“Great work. Booked for Wednesday.”*
What it became	A few afternoons a week, then chief of staff, then a partnership

One message, with no application, no introduction and nobody vouching for me.

THE MESSAGE

SENT 27 OCTOBER 2025, 3:28PM · NOTHING RETOUCHED

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☀️
🏎️

Hey Alec,

Saw your post and just had to reach out, as the outreach hacker I am.

"How did he find about me?", you're asking yourself. Well, easy. The same way I will find about your future clients to get you to +$100k per month.

Now that I have your attention, I'm Francisco, 3 things about me:

1. Moved to the UK for University at 17, started my first business at 18, made $10k organising and selling event tickets to international students (money I dropped stupidly on a watch).

2. I ran LinkedIn outreach for Farhoon Asim, yeah, the 85k+ LinkedIn follower guy, pulling in multiple $100k months by selling in the DMs.

3. Now working as a Partnerships Manager at a high-growth SaaS in Spain, have some extra time on afternoons and weekends, and would love to help you sell more RallyUp to teams!

If you want an outreach hacker who actually talks and sells like a human (not a robot), I'm your guy.

Big hug from Spain,
Francisco

The real one had a calendar link between the last two lines. I've taken it out because it's long dead.

THE ANNOTATION

01

Three emojis, never explained

A pirate flag, a sun and a racing car. I didn't explain them then and I won't now. In an inbox full of grey paragraphs they break the pattern, and they tell him a person wrote this before he's read a word.

02

The first line names his post and labels me in the same breath

> *Saw your post and just had to reach out, as the outreach hacker I am.*

He knows why I'm writing before he knows who I am. The self-label is doing a job beyond vanity, too: it's the claim the next line exists to prove.

03

The second paragraph is the whole message

> *"How did he find about me?", you're asking yourself. Well, easy. The same way I will find about your future clients to get you to +$100k per month.*

It asks the question he's already asking, then answers it by doing the thing it promises. The sentence is outreach, landing in his inbox while he reads about outreach, so he never has to take my word for any of it; the evidence is already in his hands.

> **If you take one idea from this document, take that one.** Everything else is packaging.

04

There's a typo in it

“Find about”, twice, in the best sentence I wrote. He replied in thirty minutes anyway, and I think of that whenever somebody tells me they're still polishing.

05

Then three facts, in a deliberate order

The first is self-deprecating: a business at 18, ten grand, and *“money I dropped stupidly on a watch.”* It dates the ambition and makes me sound like a person instead of a CV.

The second is the only one that matters commercially, and it carries a name and two numbers: outreach for Farhoon Asim, 85k+ followers, multiple $100k months. Anyone could check it.

Most advice says to lead with your job title. I buried mine in third place, and it's there for one reason, the clause at the end of it.

06

The weakness is on purpose

> *have some extra time on afternoons and weekends*

That tells him exactly what he isn't getting. Anyone painting a perfect picture is selling, and volunteering the awkward bit is what makes the other two facts land. He knew I had a day job before he replied.

07

“Big hug from Spain”

Nobody writes that in a cold B2B message, which is exactly why it's there. It makes the whole thing read like someone who couldn't be bothered to sound like LinkedIn.

THE FOUR MOVES

Take the story out and four moves are left. They work the same whether you want a customer, an investment, a partnership or a job.

MOVE 1

Open on their trigger

Something that happened to them recently: a post, a raise, a launch, a hire, a change on their pricing page. The trigger makes the message timely instead of random, and bad timing is most of why cold outreach fails.

Spend an evening reading them first. I went through Alec's last twenty posts before I wrote a word, to learn how he talks rather than to flatter him: the words he reaches for, how long his sentences run. Then I wrote to him in his own language.

MOVE 2

Do the work inside the message

This is the move that matters most. Whatever you're selling, put a finished piece of it in the message, unasked.

IF YOU WANT	PUT THIS IN THE MESSAGE
A customer	The analysis of their problem they haven't done, or the thing you'd fix first and why
An investor	The market read they haven't seen, or what you learned that contradicts the consensus
A partnership	The specific overlap, with the first three accounts you'd work on together
A job	A piece of the role, done: a teardown, a plan, a rewrite
A hire	What you can see about their work from outside, and what you'd build with them

Anyone can say they're good at something, and almost nobody will spend an afternoon proving it before they're asked. That gap is the whole opportunity, and it's getting wider as plausible words get easier to generate and it gets harder to tell who meant them.

MOVE 3

Three facts, no adjectives

Pick three things that actually happened, each answering a question they'd have, and put a number, a name or a date in each. Then test every sentence: if someone else could swap their own details in and it would still stand, delete it. “Passionate” and “results-driven” both fail.

Include one fact that's inconvenient to you, because it's what makes the other two believable.

MOVE 4

One action, and make it easy

A calendar link or a yes or no question, and only one. “Let me know if you'd like to chat” hands homework to the person you're asking for a favour.

WHEN THEY REPLY

A reply gets your foot in the door, and I've watched plenty of people get that far and then wait to be told what to do next. That's where it dies.

In my first month I shipped things before anyone asked for them. Nobody scoped that work or approved it; it just started existing. That's the difference between someone a company pays and someone it would struggle to operate without, and sales works the same way. A prospect who replies hasn't bought anything yet, but the one you send something useful to twice, before they've signed, often becomes a customer.

YOU CAN'T SEND FIFTY OF THESE

Each one takes an evening of reading them, finding the trigger and doing a real piece of the work. Three a week is a serious outbound practice in this format, and three good ones will beat two hundred templated ones by a margin that isn't close.

I've seen it from the other side. When we posted one role, hundreds of people applied and we only interviewed four. The rest weren't worse at the job; they'd all done the same quick thing, which is the surest way to make sure nobody can tell you apart.

WHAT THIS CAN'T DO FOR YOU

It's one message, sent to one founder who happened to be looking. I can't give you a hit rate, because I wasn't running a test; I was trying to change my life. Anyone quoting you a conversion rate on cold DMs is guessing.

It doesn't scale, by design. If you need a hundred conversations next week, use something else. This is for when one specific yes would change something.

Doing the work unasked costs real hours, and some of them go to people who never reply. That's the price, and it's why almost nobody pays it and why the thing still works.

It won't rescue a bad fit. That message put me in front of someone whose problem I could genuinely help with, and no structure fixes being wrong for the job.

THE ONE PAGE VERSION

1. Pick one person, not a list.
2. Read everything they've published recently. Give it an evening.
3. Find the trigger: something that happened to them this month.
4. Do a piece of the work they need, unasked.
5. Open on their trigger rather than your name.
6. Put the work in the second paragraph so the claim proves itself.
7. Use three facts, each with a number, a name or a date, and make one of them inconvenient.
8. Ask for one action: a link, not a request to reply.
9. Send it before it's polished.
10. If they reply, ship something else before they ask.

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